Counter Insights

Data consulting for small businesses · Wembley, London

FOR FORECOURTS, RESTAURANTS, CAFÉS AND SHOPS

Protect your margins behind the counter.

Practical data made simple for counter-service small businesses – built from the till reports and supplier invoices you already have. No new software, no jargon, just clear actions.

Your till, EPOS and supplier invoices record everything: every sale, every delivery, every busy hour. But the reports usually sit unused while you run the business, and big decisions still come down to gut feel. Large chains have analysts for this. Independents usually don't.

That's where I come in. I'm Liam Adams, a Wembley-based data consultant. I take the numbers you already collect and turn them into a short list of what to do next – where stock and waste are costing you, what really earns its place, and when you need more (or fewer) people on shift.

Who I help

Forecourts and petrol stations

Independent and dealer-run sites where fuel, shop and car wash all need to pull their weight.

- Fuel deliveries against pump sales
- Pump and shop margins
- Prices against nearby sites
- Staffing for peak hours

Restaurants and cafés

Independent restaurants, cafés and dessert or brunch spots where food cost and labour decide the margin.

- Food cost % and waste
- Menu profitability
- Prices against local competitors
- Rotas that match covers

Also: convenience stores and independent shops. If your business records sales, stock or bookings, I can probably help.

YOUR DATA, NOT MINE

I work from standard exports of your till/EPOS and supplier invoices.

PRACTICAL DATA MADE SIMPLE

No 40-page reports – just what matters and what to do about it.

PERSONAL SERVICE

You deal with me directly, in person across North West London or remotely.

WHAT I DO

Seven services, two kinds of counter

The same questions matter whether you sell litres or lattes. Here is what each service looks like on a forecourt and in a restaurant or café. Most clients start with a Business Health Check, which covers several of these in one go.

SERVICE	ON THE FORECOURT AND IN THE SHOP	IN THE RESTAURANT OR CAFÉ
Stock and waste tracking What you bought against what you sold – and where the gap comes from.	Fuel deliveries against pump sales, alongside (not replacing) your wetstock monitoring. Shop lines checked for waste, out-of-date stock and shrinkage.	Food purchases against dishes sold to show your real food cost %. Spot over-portioning, spoilage and stock that goes missing.
Margins and what earns its place See profit, not just turnover – line by line.	Pump margin against volume, and which shop categories and lines really earn their shelf space.	Menu profitability in plain words: *winners*, *popular but thin*, *hidden gems* and *problem dishes* – each with a clear next step.
Pricing vs local competitors Price with confidence, not guesswork.	Your pump prices against nearby sites using public price data, and key shop prices against local convenience stores.	Plate cost against menu price, and your prices against comparable restaurants and cafés nearby.
Busy hours and rotas Match your staffing to when customers actually come in.	Transactions by hour and day across pumps, shop and car wash – set against the hours you have staff on.	Covers and sales by hour and day against staffed hours – where you are stretched at peaks and overstaffed when it's quiet.
Supplier and delivery checks Pay what you agreed, and get what you paid for.	Fuel delivery timing and variance trends; shop supplier invoices against agreed prices, with short deliveries flagged.	Ingredient price creep, short deliveries and substitutions – plus how suppliers compare on your key lines.
Forecasting Plan ahead with realistic numbers, all assumptions shown.	Litres and shop sales for the weeks ahead, to time fuel orders and reduce the risk of run-outs.	Covers for the weeks ahead, so ordering and the rota match likely demand.
Simple dashboards Your key numbers in one place, refreshed monthly with a short "what's changed" note.	Litres, pump margin, shop sales and car wash – side by side.	Sales, covers, average spend, food cost % and labour hours.

HOW IT WORKS

Three simple steps

1

Share your data

A month of data to start, more history helps: till/EPOS reports and supplier invoices. Standard exports are fine – there is nothing new to buy or install.

2

I do the analysis

I reconcile purchases against sales, work out your margins, map your busy hours and check supplier prices – and ask you any questions in plain terms.

3

You get a clear action plan

A short written report with your priorities in order, and a walkthrough call or visit so you know exactly what to do next.

PACKAGES

Three ways to work together

BEST PLACE TO START

Business Health Check

A one-off, in-depth review of your numbers.

- Sales and margin review (fuel and shop, or menu)
- Stock and waste: purchases vs sales
- Local competitor price check
- Busy-hours vs rota heat-map
- Supplier price and delivery review
- Written report with your top five actions
- One-hour walkthrough

ONGOING INSIGHT

Monthly Insight Retainer

Regular insight without hiring an analyst. 3-month minimum, then rolling monthly.

- Dashboard refreshed every month
- One-page “three actions this month” note
- 30-minute monthly review call
- Price-watch alerts
- Quarterly review
- Email support

SPECIFIC QUESTIONS

Project Work

A focused deep dive into a specific question, scoped with you first.

- Pricing strategy review
- Stock loss or variance investigation – fuel wetstock or food waste
- Menu or shop range review
- Rota redesign based on demand
- Multi-site comparison
- Investment case – e.g. car wash, food-to-go, opening hours or a second site

Pricing tailored to your business – get in touch for a free, no-obligation chat.

What I work with – no new software needed

Till/EPOS and back-office reports, supplier invoices and delivery notes, rotas or timesheets, and booking, loyalty or delivery-platform reports where you have them. Summary data only – never card numbers.

WHY ME

Hands-on in both sectors – not just spreadsheets

I've run shifts and led teams on the shop floor and behind the counter in both sectors I know best – fuel retail and hospitality – so I understand stock, waste, rotas and margins from the inside.

Forecourts. I've managed petrol stations and worked as a Business and Systems Analyst at Engen, a fuel company, where I reviewed financial, sales and product records to find ways to reduce costs and improve profit.

Hospitality. I've supervised teams at more than one London restaurant, including Haute Dolci and Heavenly Desserts – dessert, coffee and brunch restaurants – and I still work shifts in hospitality today. I know what a busy service feels like, how quickly stock moves and what happens when the rota doesn't match the rush.

The two have a lot in common: stock checked against sales, deliveries to verify, peaks to staff for and prices set with one eye on the competition. I combine that hands-on view with experience in data analysis, data compliance (including GDPR) and information security risk, using SQL, Excel, Power BI and Python.

How I work

- **Practical data made simple.** What matters and what to do about it.
- **Your systems.** I work from the exports you already have.
- **Personal service.** You deal with me directly, every time.
- **Local and national.** Based in Wembley, visiting businesses across North West London and working remotely anywhere in the UK.
- **You stay in control.** I give you the evidence and the options; you make the decisions.

YOUR DATA, HANDLED SECURELY

PECB Certified Data Protection Officer

Your figures are commercially sensitive, and rotas, loyalty and booking data may include personal data about staff and customers. I work in a GDPR-aware way as standard:

- I only ask for the data I need
- Summary or pseudonymised data wherever possible
- Encrypted storage protected by multi-factor authentication
- I never take card numbers
- Your data is deleted when our work ends, or whenever you ask
- A written agreement covering scope, confidentiality and data handling

[Add case study once available]

Let data drive your business's future.

Book a free, no-obligation call and find out what your numbers are telling you.

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